Practical 6: Build the RetailPulse Customer Insights Dashboard

Related topic: Build a Dashboard for Customer Insights Visualization

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Objective

Assemble a dashboard combining a summary card, trend chart, segment breakdown and a shared filter widget for RetailPulse customer data.

Materials Required

IBM Cognos Analytics access, RetailPulse Customers data module.

Step-by-Step Procedure

1. Select **New > Dashboard**, choose a template layout, and when prompted pick **Select a source** > the RetailPulse Customers data module.

2. Add a **Summary** (KPI) widget: drop Active Customers into the card for the selected period.

3. Add a **Line chart**: Month on the x-axis, New Customers and Returning Customers as two series.

4. Add a **Column/Bar chart**: Loyalty Segment on the category axis, Active Customers as the measure.

5. Add a **Filter widget** (Region) at the top; open **Filters** to confirm it applies to **all widgets** on the canvas (cross-filtering).

6. Arrange widgets: KPI and filter top, trend line below, segment bar at the bottom, with no overlaps; resize and align; then **Save** as "RetailPulse Customer Insights Dashboard".

Sample Solution (Output)

View 1 - No region selected (all regions)

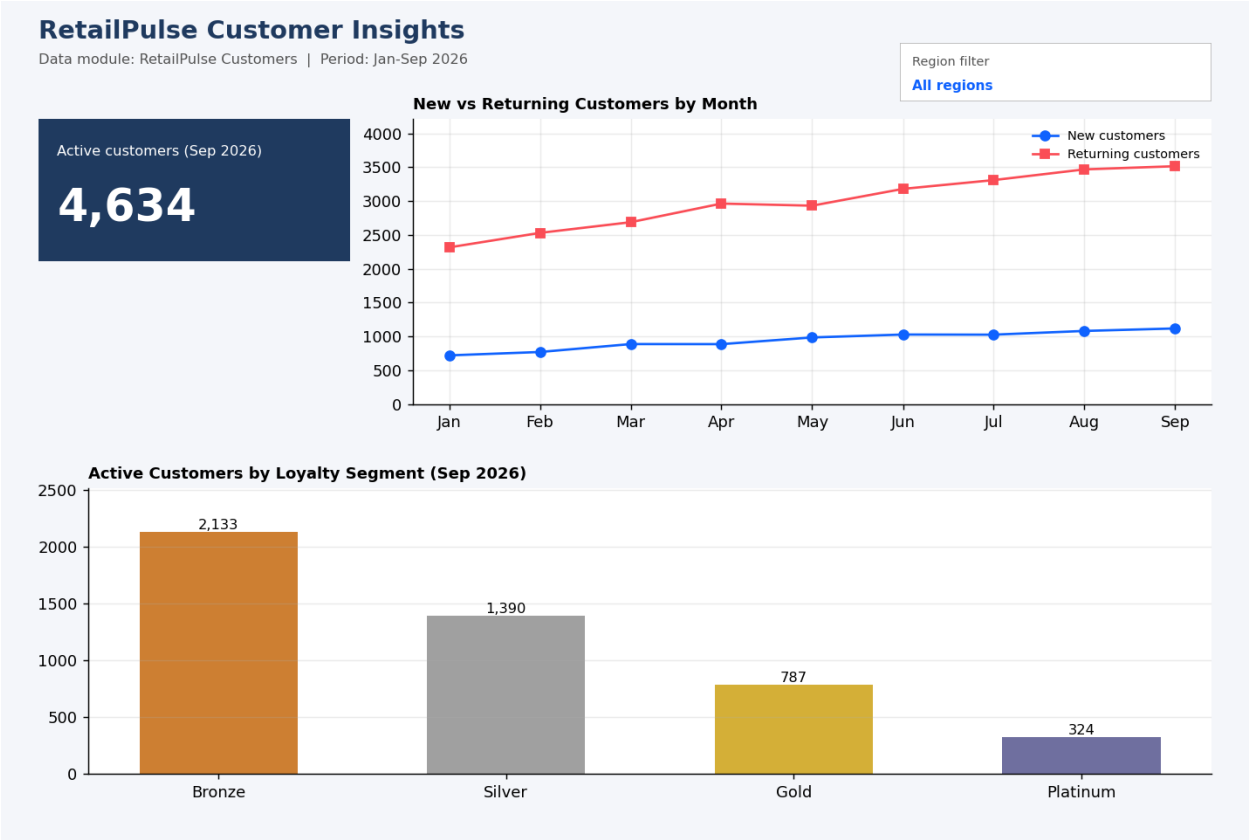


Figure 6.1: All regions - 4,634 active customers in Sep 2026.

View 2 - Region filter set to North (all three widgets update)

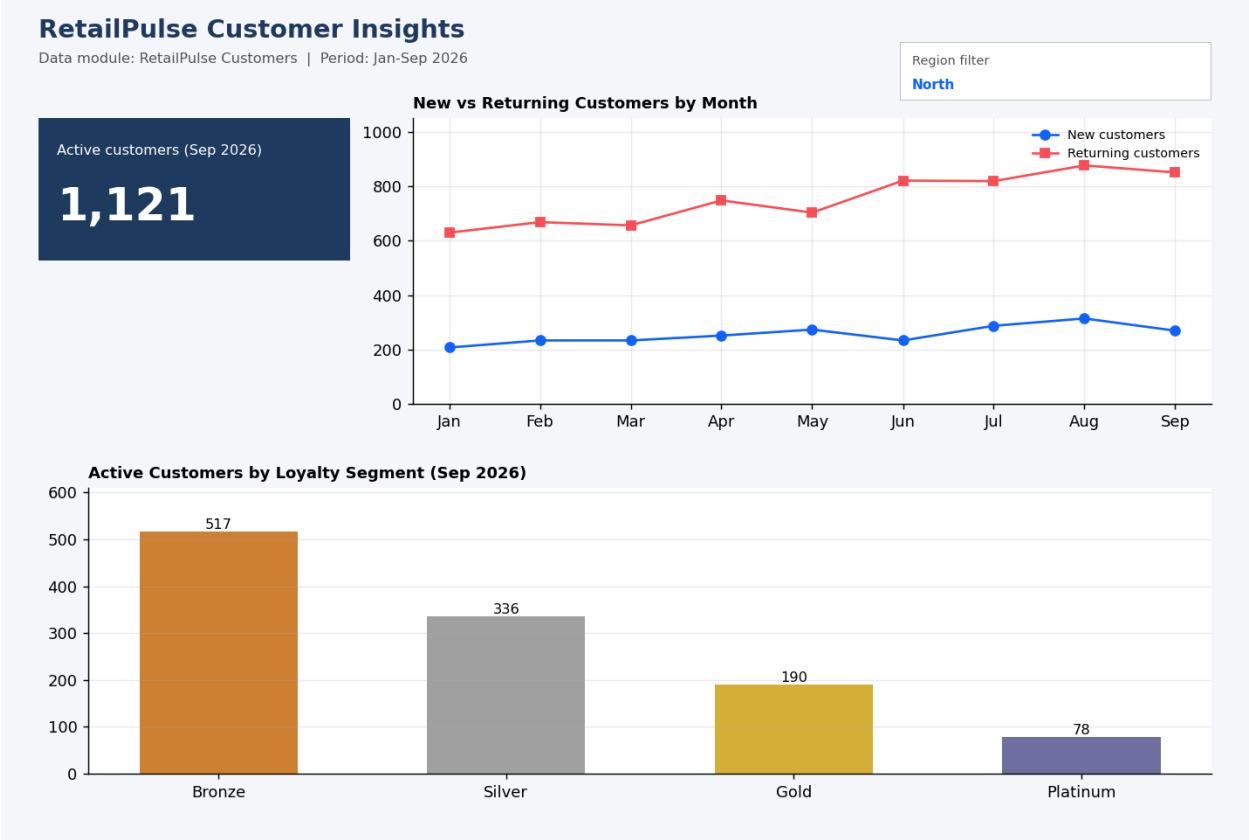


Figure 6.2: Region = North - 1,121 active customers; the card, trend lines and segment bars all re-calculate.

Layout hierarchy: top row = headline KPI + filter control; middle = trend over time; bottom = segment composition. Reading order runs from summary to detail.

What a Correct Result Looks Like

The dashboard displays a summary card, a new-versus-returning trend line and a loyalty-segment bar chart, all populated from customer data; selecting a region in the filter widget updates all three widgets consistently.

Expected Outcome

All widgets display data with no placeholder values; the Region filter widget updates every other widget consistently; the trend line renders clearly across the full period; the layout follows a clear visual hierarchy with no overlaps.

Verification Checklist

Check	Status
Summary card, line chart, bar chart on canvas	Verified
Region filter widget cross-filters all widgets	Verified
Trend line spans Jan-Sep 2026	Verified
Clear visual hierarchy, no overlaps; dashboard saved	Verified

Note on screens and data: Figures in this file are illustrative renderings of how each Cognos Analytics output looks, built from a sample RetailPulse data set (8 stores, 3 product categories, Jul-Oct 2026). All totals reconcile across Practicals 1-5. Replace them with screenshots from your own Cognos session before submission if your lab requires live captures.